ROOKIE BALL DIVISION SPECIFIC RULES

A. Organization

The Rookie Ball division shall be organized based on age and previous Little League participation. League-age 5 players who have participated in Tee-Ball for at least one season in the spring or have equivalent experience, as determined by the Player Agent, will be eligible to participate in Rookie Ball. Any League-age 6 player is eligible for Rookie Ball. League-age 7 players may be placed in the Rookie Ball division upon parent request and Player Agent approval. No league-age 4 or league-age 8 player shall play in Rookie Ball, and no exceptions will be allowed.

B. Playing Time

1. Each team's players present at a game must sit out 1 inning before any of the team's players sits out a 2nd inning. No players present at a game may sit out 3 innings.

2. No player may play any one position more than two innings in one game.

3. All players must play two infield innings per game.

4. Violation of these rules will be reviewed by the Disciplinary Committee and, by majority vote, disciplinary action will be taken as directed by the Disciplinary Committee.

C. Game

1. The game will conclude at the completion of 6 innings, or the time limit of 1 hour and 30 minutes, whichever comes first. If the time limit is reached, the inning shall not be completed. If the time limit is reached in the middle of an at bat, it may be continued until the at bat is completed.

2. No win / loss records will be kept, and there will be no league standings.

D. Players {No modification to the LLRB}

E. Lineups

1. Each team's lineup shall consist of all players present for the game.

F. Batting Order

The team batting order shall consist of all eligible players present. Players shall bat continuously in order through the entire roster, regardless of which players constitute the defensive team at any time.

G. Player Substitution

Free substitution shall be allowed to the extent that no limit is placed upon the number of times any position player can re-enter the game at the start of any half-inning.

H. Offensive Team

1. Base stealing is prohibited.

2. No bases will be awarded or taken on an overthrow.

I. Batting

1. The batter will be allowed a maximum of 5 machine pitches (5 coach pitches in the second half of the season), regardless of a "bad pitch." If the ball is not put into play after 5 pitches, a batting tee must be used. The batter gets two swings on the batting tee to put the ball into play.

2. The batter is out when:

   a. They hit a foul ball and the ball is caught by a defensive player;

   b. They successfully put the ball into play and are put out under normal rules of play; or

   c. They fail to put the ball into play after two swings on the tee.

3. "Base on Balls" and "Hit by Pitch" do not apply.

4. An arc of 10-foot radius, centered on home plate, will define the area in which a batted ball must pass in order to be considered in play. If a batted ball fails to pass this arc, it shall be considered a foul ball.

J. Base Running

1. A runner may not advance on a wild pitch, passed ball, or an overthrow in the field.

   a. Accordingly, base runners may only advance one base per hit, with the following exceptions:

      i. A ball hit over the fence in fair territory will be ruled a home run.

      ii. After 50% of the scheduled games for the season have been played, players may advance 2 bases on a well hit ball that goes beyond the outfielders.

K. Defensive Team

1. The defensive team will consist of 10 players: 1 pitcher; 1 catcher; 4 regulation infielders (1st base, 2nd base, 3rd base & shortstop); 3 regulation outfielders; and 1 outfield rover.

2. Outfielders cannot make an unassisted play at a base. Such a play will not result in an out and the play stands as is.

3. Outfielders must be lined up a minimum of 3 feet back from the edge of the infield dirt.

For the purposes of infield play requirements, the catcher position will only qualify as an inning played at an infield position for 1 inning. Players may play catcher a second inning, but it will not satisfy the minimum 2 innings of infield play requirement.

L. Pitching

1. For the first half of the season, pitching in the Rookie Ball division will be performed by a

pitching machine that is operated ONLY by an adult Manager or Coach of the current offensive team. If during the game, the pitching machine is determined to be out of working order and removed from play, the Manager who made that determination must advise the Division VP within 48 hours.

2. For the second half of the season (50% of games played) coach-pitch will be used. If both participating Managers do not agree to use coach-pitch prior to each game, the pitching machine may continue to be used. All other pitching rules for this division remain in force, including the number of pitches allowed to a batter as well as the use of a batting tee.

3. Manager or Coach Pitching

    a. The Manager or Coach shall deliver balls to the batter from a kneeling or standing position in an over-hand manner. They shall be positioned at the front of a circle with a 10-foot radius, measured 25 feet from the back of Home Plate.

    b. If a batted ball unintentionally contacts the Manager or Coach pitcher, the ball is declared a foul ball.

    c. If the Manager or Coach pitcher is hit by a thrown ball, while he/she is inside the 10-foot circle, the ball becomes a dead ball and the runners will be awarded the bases they were headed toward at the time the ball struck the team pitcher.

    d. If the Manager or Coach pitcher interferes with or is hit by a ball outside the 10-foot circle, the ball is declared a dead ball, and the base runners must return to their last occupied bases.

4. Pitching Machine Usage

    a. Only authorized adults will set up and put away the pitching machine. Managers are responsible for safety inspections and aiming tests for the pitching machines.

    b. At no time will children be allowed to touch or feed balls into the pitching machine.

    c. During the game, only Managers or Coaches will be allowed to operate the pitching machine. The team that is at bat will supply the pitching machine operator. The pitching machine will not be left unattended.

    d. Managers will be subject to disciplinary action by the Board of Directors for any violations of these rules.

    e. The home team will be responsible for setting up the pitching machine, as well as the routing of electrical power cables through the conduit. The home team Manager will be responsible to ensure the power switch is turned on and that the electrical box has been locked/secured to prevent unauthorized access.

    f. The pitching machine shall be placed in the front portion of the 10-foot circle, closest to home plate.

    g. The speed of the pitch should be fast enough that the ball could reach the catcher safely and slow enough that the batter can hit the ball.

5. Location of the Player Pitcher

a. A defensive player shall be designated the defensive pitcher. This player may be positioned anywhere on the field, provided he/she has one foot inside the 10-foot pitching circle, but may not take a position that could interfere with the Manager or Coach pitcher.

b. A helmet is not required to be worn by the defensive pitcher.

c. No part of the player may extend in front of the pitching machine prior to the ball being put into play.

M. Catching {No modification to the LLRB}

N. Coaching

1. Every effort shall be made by the Managers and Coaches of both teams to maintain control of the game. Each play and situation for offensive and defensive play must be treated as a learning experience.

2. The batting team will provide coaches in the first and third base coaching boxes. Players will not occupy these positions at any time.

3. The batter may be assisted by the Manager or Coach in positioning their batting stance.

4. 5 coaches of record are allowed in this division, if desired. This will consist of 1 Manager and 4 assistant coaches. This exception is allowed so that there is always an adult present in the dugout. Defensive coaches are allowed in the field in this division, but 1 must remain in the dugout if there are players in it.

O. Field

1. Games will be played on the Farm field.

P. Scoring

1. 5 runs or 3 outs, whichever occurs first, will retire the offensive team in each half inning. There is no “open inning” in this division.

2. The Home team will supply an official scorekeeper for the purpose of ensuring the 5-Run Rule is followed.

Q. Game Concession

Games will not be conceded based on score and will be played until such time as the game is completed or the time limit has elapsed.

R. Division Championship

There will be no championship tournament for the Rookie Ball division.

SECTION I: PLAYER ELIGIBILITY

K. Seven-Year-Old Eligibility

1. Any league-age 7-year-old that would like to be eligible for the Minor C division must attend a league-sanctioned tryout. This does not guarantee placement in Minor C.

2. All league-age 7-year-old players that attend a tryout but remain undrafted will be placed on a Farm Division Team.

3. League-age 7-year-old players may be placed in the Rookie Ball division upon parent request and Player Agent approval.

4. No league-age 7-year-old will be drafted into the Minor B division.

L. Six-Year-Old Eligibility

1. All league-age 6-year-old players who have not participated in Tee Ball for at least one season, or do not have equivalent experience as determined by the Player Agent, will be assigned to the Rookie Ball Division.

2. League-age 6-year-old players who have participated in Rookie Ball (Tee Ball prior to the 2025 season) for at least one season in the spring, or have equivalent experience as determined by the Player Agent, are eligible to participate in the Farm division (Minor League Coach Pitch).

3. No league-age 6-year-old players may be drafted into the Minor C division. No Exceptions.

M. Five-Year-Old Eligibility

1. League-age 5-year-old players with no prior experience, as determined by the Player Agent, must be placed in the Tee Ball division.

2. League Age 5-year-old players with one season of experience, as determined by the Player Agent, are eligible to be placed in the Rookie Ball division.

3. No league-age 5-year-old players may be placed in the Farm division. No Exceptions.

N. Four-Year-Old Eligibility

1. League Age 4-year-old players must be placed in the Tee Ball division.

2. League-age 4-year-old players are not eligible for the Rookie Ball or Farm division (Minor League Coach Pitch). No exceptions.